

Milestone 1 Progress Summary

Data & Scope Validation, Economic Development in Latin America (App Phase)

1. Finalize the proposed indicator list

Confirmed the following 12 indicators for the app, all sourced from the existing cleaned dataset:

- GDP per capita (current US dollars), used as the headline KPI and trend line for each country.
- GDP growth (annual percent), shows year-over-year momentum or contraction.
- Inflation, consumer prices (annual percent), shown as a trend line, with Argentina shown separately due to its scale.
- Foreign direct investment, net inflows (percent of GDP), shows investment trends over time.
- Unemployment (percent of labor force), highlights the 2020 spike and recovery speed.
- Poverty headcount ratio (national poverty lines), shown for the most recent available year, Brazil excluded.
- Life expectancy at birth (years), highlights the 2019 to 2021 health shock.
- School enrollment, secondary (percent gross), shown as a general development trend.
- Population, total, used as context for country size.
- Urban population (percent of total), used as structural context.
- Individuals using the internet (percent of population), shows the regional growth trend.
- Access to electricity (percent of population), used as context, since most countries are already near full coverage.

2. Finalize data quality rules

- Missing values are shown as “No data available,” never as zero or left blank without explanation.
- Argentina's inflation data is missing before 2018, so its chart starts from 2018 with a note explaining why.
- Brazil's poverty data is missing for the entire 2014 to 2024 period, so Brazil is excluded from all poverty charts.
- The dataset ends at 2024, so the app clearly shows this as the latest available date, with no real-time implication.
- The analysis is descriptive only, with no forecasts or predictions, matching the project's original scope.

3. Define MVP data structure

Each record used by the app contains six fields, matching the structure already used in the cleaned dataset:

- country_name (text), for example Argentina.
- country_code (text), for example ARG.

- indicator_name (text), for example GDP per capita (current US dollars).
- indicator_code (text), the original World Bank series code.
- year (number), from 2014 to 2024.
- value (number, can be empty), the indicator's value for that country and year.

4. Prepare sample data for development

Prepared a small sample of the cleaned dataset for the developer to build and test against. It includes two countries, Argentina and Brazil, across all 12 indicators, from 2014 to 2024. This sample was chosen on purpose because it already contains both known data gaps, Brazil's missing poverty data and Argentina's missing early inflation years, so the developer can test how missing data is handled from day one. The sample file was shared alongside this task in Notion.

5. Identify unresolved data questions

- Should the app pull live data from the World Bank API in a later phase, or keep using the static exported dataset for now?
- Should any of the 15 additional data sources shared for the app be added later, and if so, which ones come first?
- Is there a target audience or launch date already decided that should shape how the app looks and works?

Full detail behind these answers is documented in "data-technical-requirements-review.md," already added to the project's GitHub repository.